VS Code Chat — Claude Gateway Setup

Connecting the built-in VS Code chat to the Capgemini Claude gateway

This connects the **built-in VS Code chat** (Copilot Chat) to the Capgemini Claude gateway using your existing API key and base URL, via VS Code's **Custom Endpoint** bring-your-own-key provider. No GitHub Copilot subscription is required for chat with your own models.

Before you start

- VS Code with the Chat view available.
- Your gateway base URL: `https://anthropic.generative.engine.capgemini.com`
- Your gateway API key (starts with `sk-`). You will paste it into VS Code once; it is stored in VS Code secret storage, not in any file.

Step by step

1. Open the Command Palette with **Cmd+Shift+P** (macOS) or **Ctrl+Shift+P** (Windows / Linux).
2. Run **Chat: Manage Language Models**.
3. Choose **Add Models**, then **Custom Endpoint**.
4. Enter a group name: `capgemini`
5. Enter a display name: `Capgemini Gateway`
6. Paste your API key when prompted.
7. For the API type, choose **Anthropic Messages**.
8. VS Code opens `chatLanguageModels.json`. Fill in the model details using the block below. On macOS the file lives at `~/Library/Application Support/Code/User/chatLanguageModels.json`, so you can reopen it later without going through this menu again.
9. Save the file, then run **Developer: Reload Window** from the Command Palette.
10. Open the chat model picker. **Claude Opus 5** and **Claude Sonnet 5** now appear.

Configuration to paste

The file is a JSON **array of provider objects**. Keep the object VS Code generated — it already carries the correct `vendor` and your stored key reference — and replace only its `apiType` and `models` entries with the following. `apiType` sits at the provider level, so it covers every model in the array.

```
"apiType": "messages",
"models": [
  {
    "id": "claude-opus-5",
    "name": "Claude Opus 5",
    "url": "https://anthropic.generative.engine.capgemini.com/v1/messages",
    "toolCalling": true,
    "vision": true,
    "maxInputTokens": 128000,
```

```
    "maxOutputTokens": 16000
  },
  {
    "id": "claude-sonnet-5",
    "name": "Claude Sonnet 5",
    "url": "https://anthropic.generative.engine.capgemini.com/v1/messages",
    "toolCalling": true,
    "vision": true,
    "maxInputTokens": 128000,
    "maxOutputTokens": 16000
  }
]
```

Adding Sonnet to an existing setup

If Opus 5 already works and you only need to add Sonnet, add a comma after the Opus entry's closing brace and paste this as the second array element:

```
{
  "id": "claude-sonnet-5",
  "name": "Claude Sonnet 5",
  "url": "https://anthropic.generative.engine.capgemini.com/v1/messages",
  "toolCalling": true,
  "vision": true,
  "maxInputTokens": 128000,
  "maxOutputTokens": 16000
}
```

Three things that will break it

- **The URL must include the full `/v1/messages` path.** The bare origin works for the Claude CLI because it appends the path itself. VS Code needs it spelled out, or it infers one.
- `toolCalling: true` **is mandatory.** Without it the model is silently absent from the picker — the most common “I configured it and nothing showed up” cause.
- `maxInputTokens` **+** `maxOutputTokens` **must not exceed the context window.** 128000 + 16000 sits well inside the 200K window and is the pairing verified here.

> **No auth header override needed.** The `messages` API type defaults to `x-api-key`, which is what this gateway expects. Verified: `POST https://anthropic.generative.engine.capgemini.com/v1/messages` returns HTTP 200.

A note on skills

VS Code chat reads Agent Skills from `.claude/skills/`, `.github/skills/` and `.agents/skills/` in the workspace, and from `~/.claude/skills/`, `~/.copilot/skills/` and `~/.agents/skills/` for your user profile. Skills installed by the QRSPI kit are therefore picked up with no extra configuration, and work with either the gateway models above or Copilot's own. In a monorepo, opening the repository root will not find skills nested inside subprojects — point VS Code at them with the `chat.agentSkillsLocations` setting, or set `chat.useCustomizationsInParentRepositories` when working from a subfolder.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause and fix
Model missing from the picker	`toolCalling` not set to `true`, or the window was not reloaded. Run **Developer: Reload Window**.
HTTP 400 from the gateway	Unrecognised `id`. Use `claude-opus-5` or `claude-sonnet-5` exactly as shown above.
HTTP 401 or 403	Key not stored or expired. Re-run **Chat: Manage Language Models** and re-enter it via the gear icon beside the provider.
Picker shows only “Auto”	The workspace is in Restricted Mode. Trust the workspace.
Works in chat, not in an Agent session	Agent Host sessions need the experimental setting `chat.agentHost.byokModels.enabled`.